

Sales Training — Session 31

Build the Wall.

Scale Begins in Your Notebook.

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WHAT THIS SESSION IS A reset on time horizon. The session zooms out from the daily call sheet and asks a different question: what does the rep need to do today so that three years from now, the work feels easier, not harder? The answer is system-building — and it starts with the questions the team is already asking.

1. The 3-year mindset — give yourself the gift of time

The session opened on a single shift in time horizon. Most reps think one call ahead. Some think one week ahead. Very few think three years ahead — and the ones who do build different careers from the ones who don't. The reason is simple: a rep who thinks three years out makes today's choices in service of a future that hasn't arrived yet. A rep who thinks one call ahead is at the mercy of whatever the next call brings.

"Gift of time" is the phrase to memorise. When the rep commits to staying long enough for compounding to work, the brain starts asking different questions. Not "how do I close this call?" but "how do I make sure the next twenty reps don't have to figure this call out from scratch?" That second question is what builds the agency. The first question just survives the day.

"If you don't give yourself the gift of time, you will not activate your brain to say — next year I refuse to be answering this same question. The horizon you commit to is the horizon your behaviour reflects."

Worth noting: this isn't optimism. It's a discipline. Believing the future will be better isn't enough — the rep has to act in ways that only make sense if the future will be better. Building a wall of FAQs is one of those actions. It costs time today and pays nothing back until people arrive to use it. The rep who refuses to build it is, in effect, telling themselves they won't be here long enough to benefit. That self-fulfilling prophecy is what the session is trying to break.

2. Scale needs systems — not heroics

A founder who answers every question personally has a job, not a company. A founder who builds a system that answers questions on behalf of them has a company. The same logic applies to a senior rep. A senior rep who is the bottleneck for every new starter has a personal output that's roughly capped at their own hours. A senior rep who has built a self-serve wall of answers has output that compounds across every new starter who arrives.

Corie illustrated the move on himself. The first three days of the customer-service overhaul didn't generate any new client deals — they didn't generate anything visible at all. They

generated a system. That system, once installed, is now saving the company an estimated 10x of Corie's own output, because Corie is no longer the single point of failure for customer service issues.

"I literally took someone else's job and within three days I'd turned around the whole company — because that was my job before I assigned customer service to someone else. The system isn't the same as the work. The system multiplies the work."

For the team, the equivalent is the wall. Every question that gets asked twice should go on the wall. Every question that gets asked five times should have a video tied to it. By month three, a new rep can self-serve through 80% of their early-stage questions before they ever interrupt a senior rep — and the senior rep's time gets reclaimed for the calls that actually need them.

3. New people aren't a surprise — language reveals mindset

A subtle but pointed moment in the session. A rep referred to incoming hires as "new people coming through." The phrasing sounded innocuous. Corie stopped the conversation. "Coming through" implies they appeared — that someone got ambushed by their arrival. The right framing is "new people we're hiring." Subject and verb. We are doing it. It isn't happening to us.

This isn't a vocabulary lecture. The framing changes how the rep prepares. If new hires are an inconvenience that arrives, the rep braces and resists. If new hires are part of a plan the rep is executing, the rep prepares the seat, the desk, the training material, the wall — so the new hire feels welcomed by a structure that anticipates them. Same new hire. Two completely different first weeks.

"You said 'new people coming through' — like it just happened. They're not appearing. We're hiring. You're hiring. The language is the tell — it shows me you're behind the eight ball before they've even arrived."

Practice the reframe out loud. "We're getting new lead-gen staff in next week" instead of "there's some new people starting." "I've built training for the new hires" instead of "they're asking me a lot of questions." Subject and verb. The rep owns the growth, not the inconvenience.

4. The wall — capture every question that gets asked twice

The central action item of the session. Every question the team is currently being asked goes on the wall. Not in a Slack channel. Not in a Notion page that nobody opens. On the physical wall, visible from the desks, so a new rep with a half-formed question can look up, see it answered, and move on without interrupting the closer next to them.

How the wall works in practice:

- Each rep keeps a dedicated notepad. Every question that arrives at their desk — internal or from a client — gets logged. Not as a Slack message. As a written line. The act of writing slows the question down enough to think about it properly.
- Once a week, the team meets and reviews the notepad. Duplicates get merged. Junk gets discarded. Real questions go up on the wall with an answer underneath, plus a number tied to a video or written explainer.
- New hires get walked along the wall on day one. They're told: "if you have a question, check the wall first. If it's not up there, write it on your pad — we'll add it." That move alone reduces interrupt traffic on the senior reps by an estimated 70–80%.
- The wall grows for the first three months and then plateaus — there are only so many questions a rep can ask. After that point, the wall mostly maintains itself, and the new-hire ramp-up time drops dramatically.

"There's only so many questions one could ever ask. If you spend a 12-month period focused on answering all of them, you've built the rest of your career."

5. The teacher's curriculum — lazy and smart

A model Corie offered for thinking about the wall. Teachers don't reinvent the syllabus every year. They have a curriculum. They follow it. New students arrive — different humans, same curriculum. The teacher isn't surprised by the new students. They were always going to arrive. The curriculum was built for them.

That's exactly the move the team needs to make. A new hire isn't a one-off training emergency — they're another student arriving for a curriculum that should already exist. The first new hire is hard because the curriculum hasn't been written yet. The tenth new hire should be easy because the curriculum has been built, refined, and battle-tested.

This is what "lazy and smart" looks like. Lazy enough to refuse to do the same explanation twenty times. Smart enough to build the system once and reap the compounding savings forever. The rep who does the same explanation every time isn't being dedicated — they're being inefficient. Real dedication is to the future version of the team, not to today's interruptions.

6. Time + dedication — the 5-to-1 ratio

A working formula. "Time in the role" matters, but it's not the whole story — and it's not even the bigger half of the story. Corie's claim, calibrated against his own career: dedication is roughly 5x as predictive of outcomes as time. One year of intensely dedicated effort beats five years of just-showing-up effort.

The example: when Corie bought a new plane he couldn't yet land, he flew it daily for two weeks straight and did 50 circuits. His instructor thought he was nuts. He mastered the plane

in two weeks that would have taken most pilots two years. Same plane, same instructor, same skies. The variable was dedication compression.

Applied to the team: a rep who treats this role as a side-quest gets average outcomes regardless of how many years they're in the chair. A rep who treats it as a primary commitment compounds skills at five times the rate. "Dedication" here doesn't mean working 80-hour weeks — it means focusing the hours that are worked, refusing the easy escape from hard tasks, and engaging with feedback rather than deflecting it.

"I'm not smart. I'm just very, very dedicated. That's the key. As a young person you don't need to be doing it for years — you need to be really dedicated for the years you ARE doing it."

7. Train the new rep by going back to the rep YOU just were

A counter-intuitive coaching insight from the session. The senior rep's instinct, when training a junior, is to explain the job from their current vantage point — what they know now. That's backwards. The training the junior actually needs is the training the senior would have wanted on the day they started — back when most of this was new and most of it was confusing.

This means today's reps are in a brief, privileged window. They are still close enough to their own starting confusion to remember exactly what was confusing about it. Three years from now, that memory will be gone — fluency will have replaced it. The reps who write down their current confusions now will be vastly better trainers in three years than the reps who don't, because they'll have a record of what the new starter is actually feeling.

"You're going to have to go back to a less evolved version of yourself when you train people. The better you are at teaching someone will be based on how well-connected you are to today, in three years from now."

Practical move: every rep keeps a parallel "things I didn't know that nobody told me" log alongside the question notepad. Six months in, that log will be a goldmine for the onboarding curriculum. Three years in, it's an irreplaceable training asset that no amount of senior expertise can reconstruct.

8. The toolbox — fill it now while you can

Another mental model from the session. Every rep carries an internal toolbox. For a junior rep starting out, the toolbox is empty — just dust and moths. Every call adds a tool. Every objection handled adds a tool. Every script that lands adds a tool. The toolbox isn't given by tenure. It's built by deliberately storing what works.

The trap most reps fall into: they treat each call as a one-off event. They handle it, win or lose, and move to the next call. The tools never go in the toolbox because the rep never paused to put them there. Three years later they have three years of experience and a still-empty toolbox — because experience without capture isn't accumulation, it's just exhaustion.

The discipline: end each day with a five-minute review. Two questions. "What worked today that I want to do again?" "What didn't work that I want to avoid next time?" Write both down. The tools go in the toolbox. After a year, the rep has 200 entries — a personal sales bible no senior rep can match because they were too busy three years ago to write theirs down.

9. The hamster wheel — get on a bigger one

A reframe for reps who feel stuck in the daily grind. The session was honest about it: nobody escapes the hamster wheel. The director is on one too. The CEO is on one. The retired person who stopped running their wheel typically isn't on the planet eight years later. The wheel is the structure of having a life.

The goal isn't to get OFF the wheel. The goal is to get on a bigger wheel — one where the rep can step off briefly without the wheel grinding to a halt. That's what "is your house in order?" really means. The bigger hamster wheel has other hamsters who keep it turning when the rep takes a Tuesday off to meet their dad at the airport. The smaller wheel doesn't.

Building the wall, building the curriculum, training the next rep to actually carry the load — that's how a rep gets onto a bigger wheel. It's slow. It's invisible for months. And then one day the rep takes three days off and nothing breaks, and they realise the wheel got bigger while they weren't looking.

10. Money isn't evil — it's the lever that buys presence

A short but important reframe. Reps sometimes carry residual guilt about chasing income — a vague sense that "money isn't everything" or that wanting more is somehow grubby. The session was direct about this. Money isn't evil. Lack of money is evil — because lack of money is what makes a person unable to be present with their family, unable to relax, unable to enjoy a Saturday because they're worrying about Monday's rent.

The corollary: if a rep finds themselves around people who badmouth their financial ambition ("you work too hard" / "money isn't everything"), the rep should notice who's saying it.

Usually it's people who haven't figured out their own financial picture and are projecting. The rep doesn't need to argue — they can just stop accepting the frame. Wanting more isn't a character flaw. It's the rational response to having a life worth funding.

"If you're unkind with money, it's because you were already unkind — money just gave you the budget to be more of it. Money doesn't change character. It only amplifies it."

11. Action items for the team

1. Get a dedicated notepad by Monday. Every question you're asked — internal or from a buyer — gets logged.

2. Identify one wall in the sales room. Reserve it. By Friday, get the first 10 most-asked questions up with one-sentence answers and a reference number.
3. Reframe the language: "we're hiring" instead of "there's new people coming through." Catch yourself when you slip. Subject and verb.
4. End every day with a five-minute toolbox review. Two questions. Write down what worked and what didn't.
5. Keep a parallel "things nobody told me" log. Six months from now, this becomes the onboarding curriculum.
6. On the next training session, bring two specific questions in writing. Generic topics don't count — "how do I tackle [specific situation that happened on Wednesday at 2:15pm]" is the format.
7. Schedule a 30-minute weekly review with the team to clean the notepads, merge duplicates, and add the next round of questions to the wall.

THE RULE OF THUMB Don't be the bottleneck. Be the builder. Every question you answer twice is a question you should put on the wall once. The reps who win at scale aren't the ones with the most answers in their head — they're the ones with the most answers on the wall behind them.